SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #62 · HEAVEN

“My loved one in heaven is watching me and is disappointed in me.”

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Where it often comes from

Guilt about things left unsaid or undone before your loved one died. A parent or grandparent who was often critical while alive. Sayings like “Your mother is looking down on you.” Grief mixed with regret. Feeling that you are not living up to a loved one’s hopes.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not teach that our loved ones in heaven monitor our daily lives. It does teach that in God’s presence there will be no more crying, mourning, or pain. Those who die in Christ are with the Lord, made whole, and filled with joy. In heaven, there is joy over every sinner who repents, not disappointment. Whatever your loved one felt on earth, in heaven they share God’s perfect love and freedom from sorrow.

> *“‘He will wipe away every tear from their eyes,’ and there will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the former things have passed away”* **(Revelation 21:4)**.

Also see

> “We are confident, then, and would prefer to be away from the body and at home with the Lord” **(2 Corinthians 5:8)**.

> “You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand” **(Psalm 16:11)**.

> “In the same way, I tell you that there will be more joy in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous ones who do not need to repent” **(Luke 15:7)**.

> “Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” **(Romans 8:1)**.

Common self-statements

- Mom is watching me and shaking her head.
- Dad would be so disappointed in me.
- I let them down, and now they know everything.
- They’re upset I didn’t visit more.
- I have to live up to what they wanted.
- They see every mistake I make.

Common logical errors

- **Mind reading:** Assuming you know what your loved one in heaven thinks.
- **Projection:** Picturing them with the same criticism they may have had on earth.
- **Guilt-driven thinking:** Letting regret shape your picture of heaven.
- **Mental filter:** Overlooking that heaven has no sorrow or disappointment.

Challenging questions

- Does Scripture say my loved one is watching my daily life?
- Is there sorrow or disappointment in heaven, according to Revelation 21:4?
- What is heaven filled with, according to Psalm 16:11?
- Am I picturing them as they were at their worst on earth?
- If they are with Christ, what would they want for me now?
- Is this guilt from God or from regret?
- What regret could I bring to God instead?

Truth summary

> My loved one in heaven is not disappointed in me. In God's presence there is no more sorrow, mourning, or pain, only joy. Those who are with Christ share His perfect love. I can bring my regrets to God, receive His forgiveness, and honor my loved one by living well.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Heaven
- Grief
- Guilt/Shame
- Death/Dying
- Joy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Grief
- Death and Dying

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> **Overcoming Depression** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My loved one in heaven is watching me and is disappointed in me"

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Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My loved one in heaven is watching me and is disappointed in me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Does Scripture say they watch my daily life?
- ☐ Is there sorrow in heaven?
- ☐ What fills God's presence?
- ☐ Am I picturing them at their worst?
- ☐ What would they want for me now?
- ☐ Is this guilt from God or from regret?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ There is no sorrow or disappointment in heaven.
- ☐ In God's presence there is fullness of joy.
- ☐ My loved one is with the Lord, made whole.
- ☐ I can bring my regrets to God.
- ☐ There is no condemnation for me in Christ.
- ☐ I can honor my loved one by living well.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Revelation 21:4**
  "'He will wipe away every tear from their eyes,' and there will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain, for the former things have passed away."
- [ ] **2 Corinthians 5:8**
  "We are confident, then, and would prefer to be away from the body and at home with the Lord."
- [ ] **Psalm 16:11**
  "You have made known to me the path of life; You will fill me with joy in Your presence, with eternal pleasures at Your right hand."
- [ ] **Luke 15:7**
  "In the same way, I tell you that there will be more joy in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous ones who do not need to repent."
- [ ] **Romans 8:1**
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

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HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Regret and grace journal:** Each day, write one regret and then: "God forgives me, and my loved one is at peace."
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, Romans 8:1 becomes: "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for **Sarah**, who is in Christ Jesus."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "Grief" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Write a letter to God** about what you wish you had said or done for your loved one.
- ☐ **Read Revelation 21:1–5,** and picture your loved one free from all sorrow.
- ☐ **Do one thing that honors your loved one's good influence,** out of love rather than guilt.
- ☐ **Talk with a grief counselor or pastor** if regret is weighing on you heavily.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My loved one in heaven is watching me and is disappointed in me": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One regret I gave to God
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My loved one in heaven is watching me and is disappointed in me.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You that in Your presence there is no sorrow, only joy. Help me reject the lie that my loved one in heaven is disappointed in me. I bring You my regrets and receive Your forgiveness. Help me honor my loved one by living in Your grace. In Jesus' name, Amen.

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Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.